

Interviewer: Yes, first of all, welcome back.

Speaker: We are welcome.

Interviewer: My computer's a little old, so forgive me. It's too... Yes, we are. First of all, thank you very much again for joining our interview, [name]. As we mentioned in our message, we would like to learn more about your views on romantic relationships. We think that your experiences and perspective will contribute a lot to the project. Before we start, let me ask you again in the recording, is it okay for you to record this interview? We will only use this recording for transcription.

Speaker: Appropriate.

Interviewer: It's all right. How old are you?

Speaker: I'm [20-25] years old. I was born on [date].

Interviewer: How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker: [10-15], [25-30], sorry. Since [date]. Exactly [1-5] year, I think, recently.

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah.

Interviewer: Do you have children?

Speaker: What's that?

Interviewer: Do you have children?

Speaker: No, no, no.

Interviewer: Who do you live with at home?

Speaker: I live with my family.

Interviewer: What is your main source of income, your current job, if any?

Speaker: I am a [occupation]. My source of income is from [occupation].

Interviewer: Sure. How would you like us to address your partner? Like boyfriend and girlfriend.

Speaker: You can call him a boyfriend.

Interviewer: Okay. Can you tell me the story of how you met your boyfriend and how your relationship started?

Speaker: Sure. [laughs] Ours was completely through social media. We were following each other on [Social Media] because of our mutual friend. Then he sent me a message on a photo I shared. That's how we met. Then it continued.

Interviewer: And how did your relationship develop? Is it okay for me to ask you more questions about that?

Speaker: Of course it was convenient. I mean, at the first stage we were actually in different cities. He was a [year 1-4] student. I was in [city], he was in [city]. Then he started coming to [city] all the time. We met. We established a healthier relationship after the meeting. As you

know, these things are not very healthy over social media, in my opinion. Then he graduated. He came to [city]. After he came to [city], we started to meet more often and we actually started on a path. After we got to know each other better. Actually, this period is not a very long time. We started on a path in about a [1-4 months].

Interviewer: How would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker: I actually don't like to compare it with other relationships and I don't think it's appropriate. But if you ask me in more detail how I should compare, I can tell you.

Interviewer: We are curious about what you understand without actually comparing with your friends. We are curious about what you think for yourself on the quality of the relationship in the quality of the relationship. Obviously, it would not be very correct for me to guide you.

Speaker: I got it right. So, in our relationship, there is respect that goes beyond love. We have established a very good relationship on the basis of this respect. When we look at other relationships, I am not saying that they are in a disrespectful relationship, of course, but respect is more at the forefront in our relationship. Sometimes it even comes to the forefront of love. That's why I can say that this is the issue that distinguishes it from other relationships and increases its quality. Or the fact that we can really talk and solve everything. And the fact that our communication is strong is an issue that enriches our relationship even more.

Interviewer: Would you like to explain a little bit more why you say that?

Speaker: About what, the last one, about communication?

Interviewer: Yes. I mean, when you compare it to other relationships, you said that it is also ahead of respect.

Speaker: So in our relationship, respect is at the forefront because nobody violates anybody's private space. He always respects his comfort zone, his private space. So to give an example, he always knows when it's my me time. And here he never interferes in my space, in my time. This actually means that the way we address each other during a respectful or a fight, during an argument, our choice of words, or in general, even in our daily environments, our attitudes and behaviors towards each other are always within a framework of respect. There is no decrease in respect brought about by intimacy or a decrease in respect brought about by the years of a relationship in our relationship. I can go on and on about respect. In terms of communication, we are a couple who solve everything by talking. When we have a problem, when we see an action we don't want from the other party, and so on. We can solve our problems by talking. At least, even if we can't solve them by talking in the first stage, we solve them by talking in the later stages. That's how it is.

Interviewer: May I also ask how many romantic relationships you've had in the past?

Speaker: Actually, this is my [1-5] romantic relationship.

Interviewer: I was going to ask you what you think compared to your previous relationships, but then I'll skip the question.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: So [name], what makes a relationship high quality and high quality for you?

Speaker: I think it's actually two people having a good time together. Of course, you can do this with your friends, but it's not just sitting together, going to the movies and so on, or doing something, doing an activity. Even sitting in the car together. I mean, even sitting in the park together. I mean, if having that person with you is enough for you, then I think you have found what you are looking for in a relationship.

Interviewer: Low quality...what makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker: I'm sorry, I couldn't hear you.

Interviewer: I'm so sorry. How does it sound right now? I can move the mic a little bit closer.

Speaker: It's coming now.

Interviewer: So what makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker: Low quality.

Interviewer: Yes.

Speaker: So I think that's what makes it low quality. I mean again, I'm actually going to say the same things, but it's the opposite of what I'm talking about. I mean, couples who instantly turn against each other during a fight or... I don't know, there can be couples who simplify the concept of lovers. I mean, dating means sex life. I mean, no. You can share everything. You can share your happiness, unhappiness, work life, friend life, everything. I think the worst relationship, and by bad I mean the most unhealthy relationship I see, is the one that can't share anything with each other.

Interviewer: Okay. Do you want to explain a little bit why you say that? For both high quality and low quality.

Speaker: I mean, in low-quality relationships, I think people can't share everything. I mean, I'm giving an example... I give an example. If I can talk about the problems I have during the day on the bus, that is, the problems in the place where I sit with my friends, what my friends are talking about in the place, my friends' problems, everything during the day, this shows that my relationship is more sharing, more open to communication. On the contrary, what I gave as an example are couples who are completely disconnected from each other. Couples who meet only when they meet and spend time together, in my opinion, the quality of the relationship can be lower.

Interviewer: So can you say that they are close relationships, sharing and open to communication?

Speaker: Yes, I can.

Interviewer: How does a relationship, how does a person know that they are in a relationship that is sharing or communicative, where they can have a good time? Can you tell us a little bit about that?

Speaker: So you can know, I'm very sorry...Can I take the question again?

Interviewer: Question. I mean, how does a person know that the relationship they're in is a relationship where they can have a good time, where they can share and communicate, where communication is open?

Speaker: He can understand it like this. I mean, if you're with the person you're with all the time and you want to be together all the time, I think it's an instinct that you're more sharing and open to communication... actually, I think it's an instinct that comes from wanting to share everything more. I mean, you're together all the time. It's okay if we don't see each other one day. But no, I should tell him what happened on that day or we should talk to each other on that day. This is an indication that you are more sharing and more open to communication if you want to tell him/her about a bad event, a good event, if that person comes to your mind first, you are more sharing and more open to communication. Actually, this is also connected to what I said during a fight. If during a fight there is an effort to solve the problem without hurting each other, this is more because of good communication and respect. In this way.

Interviewer: When in your relationship can you say that you are most communicative and sharing?

Speaker: After the first [5-10] months, obviously. Maybe after [5-10] months.

Interviewer: Would you like to elaborate a bit more? Why after [5-10] months.

Speaker: Maybe if you ask my partner, you may get a different answer, but that's how it is for me. Because we didn't have a problem again. But from my point of view, from my side, there was a problem. I didn't think I was connected enough and I didn't think I felt love, so I was hesitant to share these things I was going through with him or to establish a strong communication with him. Actually, I shouldn't say I was hesitant, but I was doing it, but I don't know if I was doing it very healthy, I don't know if I was doing it as I wanted from him. That's why I can say that when my love was fully established, after that, my expectations in the relationship, the situations that I didn't expect became clearer for me. I started to show it more.

Interviewer: When was the least time? This is for you to be open to communication and sharing in the relationship. I'm sorry, I didn't finish the sentence.

Speaker: When do you think it was the lowest? I would say from the [1-5] month to the [5-10] month. I mean, that was our worst period because that was the worst period.

Interviewer: If you want to elaborate a little bit more, I mean, do you want to?

Speaker: So it's actually the same as the other thing I said. In the first months, of course, because it is a period of getting to know each other and you want to get to know each other, you can communicate more, you can be more sharing. But after the first [1-5] months, more things can dawn on you. After that, you pull yourself back a little more. And you make an effort, you wonder where I am, am I in the right place, am I doing the right things? You don't know, and I can say that this is the period when I drowned the most in this complexity. In that period, of course, I couldn't do the things I expected from this relationship.

Interviewer: What are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker: What's that?

Interviewer: What are the most important things in a relationship for you? I mean, you actually touched on it a little bit before. But I wanted to ask if you want to elaborate more.

Speaker: No, actually, the things I'm talking about are completely. If I say it as a concept, love, respect, being able to share everything, being able to do everything together. And being able to have a really proper valid communication.

Interviewer: Why do you think that?

Speaker: Actually, as I answered in other questions. I mean, without love, you can share anything you want, whether it's respect or anything else, none of that matters at some point. It's no different from your friends or your family. But when there is love, I'm talking about romantic love. When there is love, just love doesn't work, it doesn't work. Because when it's just love, when the others are not there, you lose your self-respect for each other. Couples lose respect for each other. As long as they cannot share, they enter a vicious circle. As long as there is no communication, maybe they cannot even find something to enter a vicious circle. That's why these concepts are important to me.

Interviewer: So [name], what is love for you?

Speaker: I mean, I more or less anticipated this question, but I don't think I have the answer.

Interviewer: You have time if you want to think about it some more. But of course you don't have to answer.

Speaker: Let me think a little more. I don't know, I can't really say much about it, because I can't even ask myself the question of what love is, or if you are in love.

Interviewer: If you want to tell someone in one sentence

Speaker: I mean, maybe I don't know. I mean, I think love is the explosion of love, love for the opposite sex, romantic love. Intense pressure. But I also think it's temporary, I mean, I think love is more permanent. But of course, falling in love and the concept of love is when the person you love, at a certain point in a certain period, at a certain point, that love is a ball and it turns into love.

Interviewer: How important is love in a relationship?

Speaker: What's that?

Interviewer: How important is love in a relationship?

Speaker: I think it doesn't really matter. Because if I give an example from myself. I mean, I can't ask myself this question, but I'm in a relationship. And I'm in a happy relationship right now. And from what I see around me, I mean, most people can't say, "Am I in love with him?" But they know that they love him. So is love very necessary, is love overrated? I don't know if what we call love is something that is in love, so I forgot the question while I was answering it.

Interviewer: How important is love in a relationship? I asked

Speaker: So, not love, but love is very important, of course.

Interviewer: How do you know if your boyfriend loves you?

Speaker: I can totally tell by his interest. I mean, I think it's all about interest, being thoughtful. So it's like... I always put it like this, actually. He always has his hand on the back of my neck.

Interviewer: Pardon me.

Speaker: Imagine that a person's hand is always on your neck. But it is not a touch that will harm you and make you feel that hand. On the contrary, it is such a touch that supports you, protects you. I always give myself such an example. So there is nothing restricting me. There is nothing pushing me. But the fact that he is completely protective of me and that he is always my home, a person whose hand I feel on my neck. Actually, this also shows his love. Because why would a person who doesn't love you do that? Why would he think about you all the time? All the time... I give an example: Even when I have a fight with a taxi driver. How can he think about how to make me happy even at that moment?

Speaker: So what's the relationship...

Interviewer: Oh, I'm so sorry.

Speaker: I was already finishing it.

Interviewer: Please continue.

Speaker: That's why... I forgot what I was gonna say. I'm so sorry.

Interviewer: I'm sorry.

Speaker: It doesn't matter, please go on.

Interviewer: So if you want to take a little more time, we can wait for it to come to you. Whatever you want. Actually, that's exactly what we're talking about. Why would someone who doesn't love you do that? He's supporting you, protecting you. I think you gave the example of the van. If you want to continue with that...

Speaker: I mean, what I mean is... Every minute, of course, I don't mean that it's a thought that will get in the way of his own flowing life. I don't mean constant attention, of course, but... You know, at least thinking about me even at lunchtime at work or thinking about me in daily life... ...him trying to lift me up when I'm down. Questioning why I'm down. I mean, I think they're all important things.

Interviewer: What do you think are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker: I think the biggest difficulty is that the love of the other party is too much and this leads to too many mistakes. It leads him to mistakes. That's the biggest problem, that's the problem at the beginning of all the problems we've had so far.

Interviewer: Would you like a little more of this love to prevail?

Speaker: Yes, of course. I mean, of course, in every relationship, both parties don't love equally. It's a normal thing in every relationship. So, you know, in our relationship... ...of course I'm going to say it's my opinion, but it's also the other person's opinion... ...his love outweighs hers. I mean, his love is more intense. And that's why... ...his attention is too much for me for a while. I get tired of him and we have problems. There's a period when his jealousy is too much and we have problems. And when we take the defense of loving too much as a defense for all of

these, all of these become problems for us. I mean, these are not the problems that we have encountered very recently, of course, but in the end, this is the problem that we see as the biggest problem.

Interviewer: And do you and your boyfriend fight?

Speaker: I didn't hear you, but...

Interviewer: I'm so sorry. If it's better like this....so there's a little bit of ambient noise...I'll try to get as far away as I can, then. I'm really sorry. Normally I was going to have our meeting at home, but the internet is down at home, so I came here in a hurry.

Speaker: It doesn't matter.

Interviewer: I'm really sorry, [name]. Is she better now? I moved a table.

Speaker: Yes, it's better.

Interviewer: Okay, great. So please let me know if my voice is overpowering again, if there is anything I can do.

Speaker: It's done.

Interviewer: I was just asking, uh. Do you and your boyfriend fight?

Speaker: So yes, we do. We never forgive.

Interviewer: And how often would you say these fights happen?

Speaker: I mean, what do you actually mean by a fight? Does it include small arguments or are you talking about prolonged and loud fights?

Interviewer: So if you want to include them, they can be included. What is important for us is that you understand the fight.

Speaker: I mean, I would say [1-5] a month.

Interviewer: How do you solve these fights?

Speaker: These fights are actually...

Interviewer: I'm so sorry [name]. I realized I missed a question. I'm sorry.

Speaker: It is not important.

Interviewer: Exactly that question was important. That's why I couldn't really ask it behind you. I'm sorry. I was going to ask you what these fights are about.

Speaker: What are these fights about?

Interviewer: Yes.

Speaker: I mean, I can't really think of anything specific. I can't say it's because he's jealous all the time. Or I can't say it's always about something else, but if I need to give an example: I mean, actually fights happen because of the things that the environment we are in at that moment brings rather than our own personal characteristics. That's why I can't give a specific

example. I mean, we are in another house together, I'm giving an example from our last fight. And in that house, when there was a small argument between us, when I wanted to get away, when he wanted to contact me very closely, our last fight was one of such fights. I mean, I can't say anything very specific, but in general we have arguments, of course we have fights. [1-5] a month. But there is no such specific reason.

Interviewer: Okay, I can call it an argument instead of a fight.

Speaker: You can say yes.

Interviewer: How do you resolve these debates?

Speaker: Through communication. I mean, even if I can't say something that I'm uncomfortable with at that stage, I can say it in a day or two afterwards. Maybe this can be something that will be my self-criticism too. I can't say it at that stage because it may not happen that day or the next day, it depends on the level of the fight. But I share and solve the problem within a day or two at the maximum. Since we never encounter a situation such as the other party not understanding or seeing nonsense in a problem I share, we actually solve it in a short time because they meet it with complete understanding and empathy. The important thing for us is not to solve the fight, but will it continue? Will we fight over this problem again? We are most often actually...if I need to give a specific example....the reason for fighting is the reliving of our past fights.

Interviewer: Well, you said that you solve them through communication and you said that you actually solve them by sitting down and sharing the problems. Other than that, what are the other ways to maintain your relationship?

Speaker: Are you asking during a fight?

Interviewer: No, no, no.

Speaker: How to maintain a relationship?

Interviewer: Yes. I mean, apart from communication, apart from sharing, what are the other ways of maintaining your relationship?

Speaker: I think keeping the dynamic of the relationship. I think both sides should always add a new color to the relationship. So something new should come out from the inside, or something new should come in from the outside. Here's what I mean by that: When a relationship becomes too ordinary, "let's have a getaway this week" or "let's make a plan with our friends this weekend" or having something in common, a hobby, a...I don't know, an activity done together, it could be sports, it could be a dance course. So I think after a certain point, especially after a certain period of time, new colors should be added to the relationship and it is necessary to keep the dynamic constantly dynamic.

Interviewer: Since I am also a student, like you, I need to take a short break from the interview and go to another link. Actually, this zoom has 7 minutes. If you don't mind if I ask you a few more questions... ..then we can take a five minute break... ..because after the zoom closes, I have to add a link again and I don't want to interrupt you. Is that okay with you?

Speaker: Suitable for.

Interviewer: Okay, thank you very much. Then I'll continue asking questions if that's okay with you. Where were we? Yes, last time you said that new colors should be added to the relationship. My other question is, would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker: So right now, yes, I would say so. So is it a perfect relationship, of course not. But is it a good relationship, yes, it's a good relationship.

Interviewer: May I ask why?

Speaker: I mean, it's like, I think it's perfect, actually why, and this is a bit of a complaint, but... ...I don't think there is a perfect relationship. I mean, there shouldn't be... ...I don't think it's inherent in human nature. I mean, what is a perfect relationship? A perfect relationship is when he understands without you thinking about it, when you don't have a problem with something and he already has a problem with it, when there is no problem in a relationship. I mean, I'm talking about him, the other party. Being disturbed by a general behavior. So there shouldn't be anything. These things make a relationship perfect. A healthy relationship, a relationship that should be a healthy relationship is a good and beautiful relationship. That's why I said good, but of course a perfect relationship is not good either.

Interviewer: Can you give me an example of a time when your relationship was good? Can you give examples of this relationship being good?

Speaker: I can give an example like this. We think that we are able to fulfill the things that a relationship brings, whether it is really responsibilities, behavior, love, attitude towards each other. I couldn't summarize. I mean, I forgot the question, I'm sorry, I got a little distracted.

Interviewer: No problem at all. Let me ask you again. I asked you for concrete examples that come to your mind when you think this relationship is good for you.

Speaker: Hmm, concrete examples. I mean, when I'm sitting somewhere and I'm actually sitting with him without getting bored, that's a really good relationship, okay. But what do I share with him? Do I really share my real feelings, my real thoughts? That's also a really good relationship, okay. But does the other person share with you in the same way? Is it reciprocal? If it's mutual, then that's a good relationship, okay. So basically, is the love mutual? Okay, the levels may be different, but do you feel a mutual love? This is of course what a good relationship brings. I mean, at least when you are sitting somewhere and you enjoy touching each other and you have a conversation and at the end of this conversation there is no discussion, of course there are contradictions, but if you take them to the discussion part or if you take it to another level, I cannot call it a good relationship. But if you are happy to really touch each other, to touch each other's heart, I'm talking about physical contact, if you are happy to experience all of that and if you are happy to be with that person, to be in that environment, then it's a really good relationship. You know, of course, I don't attach a lot of meaning to it, that it would be good if this happens. No, I mean it's very simple. I mean, if you are happy when you are together, if you have physical attraction, if you have a high level of sharing, communication, respect and love for each other, this relationship is good. You add to it, you add extra activities, you add extra experiences together. You experience sadness, you experience love, you experience happiness. We also experience these things. I go through a class, we go through it, he starts a job, we go through it. All of these are actually things we share in common with each other. That's why I can give such an example.

Interviewer: Thank you very much [name]... ..as you can see... ..we have very little time left on the zoom... ..so if you wish, I'll close this session on zoom... ..and then I'll give you a second link after that. We actually have a few more questions left. We don't have many questions left, but don't be interrupted.

Speaker: Okay, I'll be waiting then. Thank you very much

Interviewer: I'll send you the new link on [Social Media] now. See you in two minutes.

It's done. See you soon.

PART 2

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: Yeah. Uh-huh. Where were we?

Interviewer: Another question, [Participant's Name], has this relationship changed you?

Has this relationship changed me? I mean, I think of course it changed me. Because as I mentioned at the beginning, it was my first relationship and since I hadn't been in a relationship before, I didn't really know the things that a relationship brings and I realized that I was completely libertarian and I didn't act against anything by thinking about a relationship in the first stages. But then I realized that this was actually due to the maturity of my age and my environment and what I saw. Of course I was keeping up with the things that the relationship brought, but when I couldn't keep up somewhere, just a second. Sorry, the phone rang.

Interviewer: If you want, I can stop the recording if you want to open it

Speaker: No, it's nothing. It's not an important meeting.

Interviewer: It's done.

Speaker: I mean, this actually changed me of course. Because you can't see yourself in every relationship. Actually, they can see themselves at some stage. Of course, it's not being restricted, but of course there are some things that come with having someone in your life. I had a process of accepting these. I mean, I'm basically just informing my father and my mother, but also informing one more person. And I was a person who was actually uncomfortable even with that. So for example, I have refined myself more in this regard and yes, this is the way it should be, if he is in your life, of course he will be informed. Where you go, where you are, who you are with. In this regard, yes, a little bit. But if I perceive the question as my personality traits have changed. Did it change my personality traits? No, it didn't. I mean, I am actually the same now as I was at the beginning of that relationship. I am the same now as I was without the relationship. So it didn't change me as a character. But of course the relationship played a big role in my self-correction in the responsibilities brought by the relationship. Whether it's the issue of informing, informing, or in situations where he interferes with me, when I warn that he can't, I mean he shouldn't, with the reactions I get from my environment, from my close circle, no, he can at some point. No, that's his right too, when I get feedback like that, of course, I feel more active and more honed in the responsibilities brought by the relationship.

Interviewer: Do you think your boyfriend changed during this relationship?

Speaker: I think let me think for a second. I think he hasn't changed. I mean, he was like that from the very beginning. But he may have been honed to the opposite side of me. Because it's always, as I just mentioned, too much love, too much attention, too much love, too much jealousy, too much love, too much awareness. So when I didn't write for 5 minutes, problems could arise. But now we don't face those problems. He may have actually toned himself down at this stage. But as a character or as a characteristic, I was the same way and he was the same way at first. But of course, whenever he felt that the other party was uncomfortable, I think he filed them down from too much attention or too much jealousy or too much feeling of being informed.

Interviewer: You touched on it a little bit, but I would like to ask again. Do you think the person you were before the relationship is the same person you are now?

Speaker: Yes, it's the same.

Interviewer: Why do you think that?

Speaker: Because I always think that a relationship is not something that you can change your life, change yourself. I mean, why can you change your character? Why would you change your character? I mean, the main thing is to enter a path with a person without changing them so that you don't have any problems afterwards. And when can you love and embody a character that you have changed, a character that you changed at the age of 25? Or how can you internalize it yourself? I was not a jealous person before the relationship. Now I say I am a very jealous person. No, I mean you are not a very jealous person. You can polish it, it's not a personality trait. Let's say before. I mean, I'm giving you an example. I was a really independent person. I still am. Because I adapted it into the relationship. So I am free in that relationship too. I don't go out of the city or abroad because I'm in a relationship. I mean, I was already doing these things before. I had a libertarian spirit in the past. I have a libertarian spirit now. That's why I don't think I've changed. I think it's okay for me to change, too, to be polished at some point. But changing is not okay.

Interviewer: And is your boyfriend the same before the relationship as he is in the relationship?

Speaker: I think it's the same. I don't think he's changed either, because I think that if two people change, they're going to falter at some point, so change. I mean, I think changing is very opposite from my point of view, and you know, it was A, it became B. Not that it was black, it became white, but it was A, it shifted a little bit. It was B, it moved a little bit. And this actually comes from the issues I was talking about. Too much love, I mean, you may have grown up in a very okay, loving family. You may show me a lot of love too. But when I take this from this love, I am not saying that you should be unloving. I'm just telling you to moderate your love. And because he moderates his love, he doesn't change his character. He only changes the level of his projection. That's why I don't think that he has changed either. I think that the relationship has made our sharp areas even more oval.

Interviewer: So [Participant's Name], do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker: Yes, I feel it.

Interviewer: Can you explain a little bit more why you say that?

Speaker: I mean, I'm not the kind of person who can be in a relationship where I don't feel safe. When I'm telling him, telling you something, sharing something together, I'm telling him a secret, an example, an achievement, even a future plan. I am a person who is afraid of people even talking about a future plan, but when I first think of a future plan, a different dream, I talk about it first with my partner. And this is the biggest indicator that I trust him. If he is physically safe, I mean of course you feel safe when you are with him. I mean, because as I've always mentioned, when I'm with him, I feel that he makes me feel completely safe. You know, when I was away, I felt it in the back of my neck. When I'm with him, of course I feel it in my arms. So I'm not the kind of person who can do it with a person I'm not safe with. That's why I feel safe both in terms of trust as a feeling, trust in his character, trust in his behavior, and I also feel safe against threats from outside when I'm really with him.

Interviewer: Now I am going to ask you a few questions, but since you are a student of psychology, these questions will be in the form of a Likert scale with a numbering format. So actually, I actually put them on paper for easy visualization. If we start with our first question, first of all I will show you the paper. Can you read it or can you see it? Let me ask you that.

Speaker: I think "My partner usually really listens to me" is somewhere between not true and completely true.

Interviewer: Yes, between one and nine. Yes, okay, when you look at it like this. If I ask you, "My partner usually really listens to me", between one and nine, one being "not true at all" and nine being "completely true". Which one would you consider appropriate for your own relationship?

Speaker: Eight.

Interviewer: I got it. Uh, just a second. I'm coming up with a new question. I hope you can see it.

Speaker: Yes, "My partner is usually sensitive to my needs"

Interviewer: Question. If I asked you, "My partner is usually sensitive to my needs", what would be your answer from one to nine?

Speaker: So it could be seven.

Interviewer: So why did you answer eight for "my partner usually really listens to me"?

Speaker: I mean, I don't think we have a problem in terms of listening, but I am also a person who always avoids extremes.

Interviewer: So, are you okay, [Participant's Name]?

Speaker: Sir?

Interviewer: I asked if you were okay. I thought something happened.

Speaker: Yes, yes, I think I drank water from talking too much. I mean, I hesitated to give him a nine, to be honest, I hesitated like this. Because, well, if he listened very well, would we have to discuss again on the issues we had discussed before? We wouldn't. I mean, I always tell him that. That's why I gave him an eight, because this is a really important issue for me. Because you've figured it out, you've listened to me, you've understood me and we're discussing the

same topic again. That's why I can't give you a nine, that you listened to me very well, completely well. That's why I gave it an eight. Because I believe that you really listen and, uh, you want to listen. Well, and I gave it an eight because I mentioned that it's a relationship based on communication.

Interviewer: So, can you give concrete examples of this happening? This listening you're talking about. For the reasons that led you to give an eight, actually

Speaker: I mean like this, before, I'm a person who is uncomfortable with him calling me in front of my friends, calling me constantly, I mean constantly, for example, texting me every half hour, every ten minutes, and I'm a person who expresses this. And when I expressed this, I saw that he really understood and listened to me, that he didn't bother me in front of my friends, that he only waited for a message from me, even if it was for 2-3 hours, that he only used texting for communication purposes. And this is a sign that he listened and really understood that I was uncomfortable. Well, I can give this as a concrete example.

Interviewer: So, why eight and not seven or nine? Actually, you answered a little bit about nine. But, uh, if you want to tell us about seven.

Speaker: I mean, as I gave the answer of nine, I couldn't give a number as ambitious as nine because of the problems we had again, because I thought I wasn't being listened to, so I couldn't give a number as ambitious as nine, I gave eight. If you ask why I couldn't give seven, seven is like this, you know, I really believe it's eight, even if it's not nine, because I'm in a relationship where I'm really listened to, I'm really tried to be listened to, and I'm in a relationship where this is tried to be implemented. In other words, the other party may have a defense, not as not listening, but as listening but not applying it. He listens, ok, he understands, ok. But he cannot apply it. Why love too much? Why thinking too much? That's what he's always saying. That's why it's not really a cruel trick to give a seven as much as a seven and be cruel. But I thought eight was more appropriate.

Interviewer: So, when I asked you, "My partner is usually sensitive to my needs", you answered seven. So, may I ask why you gave that answer?

Speaker: I mean, I was talking about spiritual needs. Well, because materially we don't have such an expectation from each other, such a desire at this stage. When I think about it spiritually, okay, he is sensitive to my needs, I can feel that he is sensitive at some point. But, uh, at some point, I think I distinguish between men and women. We have a broader mentality as a female mentality and we have a mentality that thinks through more channels. But I think men are flatter, so when he says something to me, when I say something to him, he actually has to do it before I say it. He can understand after I say it, for example, to give an example, I get offended at some point. Something with his family, for example. But this one doesn't realize it. Well, let me give another example, a concrete example. The last incident we had is like this. He invites me home. And when I was going to accept the offer, I don't refuse the offer out of politeness, I just ask something extra. And after asking something extra, the offer is withdrawn. And when this offer is withdrawn, I can think about whether he talked to his mother and withdrew it, or whether his family didn't want me, and I can get hurt about it. And this, too, he has to understand that. Because at that moment I'm entering a new family, I'm going to meet a new family, and this is something I really need. If I've made an introduction, I don't want to be invited afterwards. Then I know that I am asked to be there. All of this is actually a spiritual need for me at some point. But it's not very appropriate for him to put them on the back burner and

withdraw them. I mean, I think that he should look at things a little bit more deeply and from different places than I do, spiritually. That's why I gave him seven.

Interviewer: Why 7 and not 6 or 8?

Speaker: I mean, I couldn't give a 6. Because 6 would be a really inappropriate number for me. Because I don't think a person who cares about these things, a person who cares about these things, can be happy in a relationship where they give 6. Because 6 is a low number for me. Because if I give 6, I'm not being fair to the other party. That's why I couldn't give 6. But 8, maybe I might have been a little bit influenced by this recent incident. Because it is a very new, recent event. That's why I didn't consider myself very suitable to give 8. That's why I gave seven.

Interviewer: I hope you don't mind me asking this question. Because you mentioned earlier that physical intimacy is important for a relationship. And if this is something very sensitive for you to share, please feel free to say so, but I wanted to know about your physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker: We are not living.

Interviewer: So, how satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker: So right now, we think that we are actually experiencing things in line with the expectations of both sides. Since we are in a relationship where we try to spread everything over time and try not to consume everything all the time in a relationship, I think we are a couple who think to live more confidently, more slowly, at the right times.

Interviewer: Would you like to explain a little bit more why you say that?

Speaker: About what? I mean, it's a little bit like actually disrupting the dynamics of the relationship that we always talk about or keeping the dynamics always active. I mean, for example, I don't know, maybe it's a different thought, but I always think that everything should not be consumed in a relationship in the first place. I mean, of course I respect those who live, of course every relationship is different. But in my relationship, everything is slower, everything can happen at a time that both parties want, at a time that they see fit. That's why we don't have an active sex life right now. In this way.

Interviewer: I'm going to ask you one more scale question, I hope you can see it. It goes like this: How satisfied are you with your relationship in general? The first option is "completely dissatisfied". And at the bottom, "completely satisfied". I can read the options in between if you wish. "Very dissatisfied". Under "completely dissatisfied", "not sure, undecided", "somewhat satisfied", "very satisfied", "completely satisfied".

Speaker: I can say I'm very satisfied.

Interviewer: If 0 is not satisfied at all and 10 is completely satisfied, how would you rate the satisfaction of your relationship on this scale?

Speaker: I can give 9.

Interviewer: Why did you answer 9?

Speaker: If we look at it like I'm completely satisfied or it's a perfect relationship, 10 is the number one for me. "I can't remember if it was ten or nine, the last number.

Interviewer: Yeah, it was 10.

Speaker: 10 is a really ambitious number for me. So if it was a very perfect and very smooth relationship, we wouldn't have problems. Or there was a period where I was questioning myself, that wouldn't have happened, or it would have been a relationship where both parties were very happy. So while I cannot say it so openly, so assertively even to myself, it is not possible for me to say it in a relationship, in a situation where a different person is involved. That's why 9.

Interviewer: You've explained a little bit why it's not 10. Why not eight?

Speaker: Because in our relationship, what I wanted, what I actually wanted, what I expected from the relationship and what I didn't expect, 8 would have been too little for us because I think it met most of them and we worked really well. As much as 10, 10 would have been ambitious, 8 would have been less, so number 9 is more ideal

Interviewer: [Participant's Name]?

Speaker: I'm hearing it right now

Interviewer: You can hear it right now, right?

Speaker: Yes, I'm hearing it now.

Interviewer: Yes, last time you said 8 would be too little and 10 would be ambitious. I didn't hear anything after that.

Speaker: Actually, I finished it after that. It's not an 8 because I think that way.

Interviewer: So, did your relationship with your boyfriend live up to your expectations?

Speaker: Yes, he met me at some point. Of course, again, I can't say that it met it completely, because actually I was the part that rased it in a relationship, so I don't want to put it in a situation like I created my own boyfriend, but I don't want to put it in a situation like I created my own boyfriend. I mean, since I, of course, by talking a lot and constantly voicing the things we are uncomfortable with, I make the other person what I expect from the relationship for me, the person I expect, of course, it meets my expectations at some point, at least at this point.

Interviewer: Yes [Participant's Name], we are about to finish our interview. I would like to summarize what we talked about in the last hour. Yes, you are [21-25] years old, you live with your family, you are a [occupation]. You said that love is more important than love. You conceptualized that ascension is actually a culmination of love, of love. That love and respect should be together in a relationship, that private spaces should be respected. You mentioned that you met your boyfriend through social media, that it is important to have a relationship that is sharing and open to communication, and that this relationship is how you actually resolve conflicts. Were these things true at first, is there anything you would like to add?

Speaker: Yes, that was right, is there anything I want to add? Let me think about it. No, no, I have nothing to add.

Interviewer: And how comfortable were you in talking about these issues?

Speaker: I mean, frankly, I don't know, maybe it is a necessity of my profession, but I am already very open, I don't have any uneasiness, I don't have any extra thoughts. I don't feel uncomfortable explaining and sharing things as they are.

Interviewer: Thank you very much again for your time and interest. Before we finish, I would like to talk to you about how we will handle the data. As a research project, we want to be as ethically transparent as possible. Therefore, we will actually ask you to decide which data sharing option is best for you. The first option is to share parts of the transcript of the interview. None of these transcripts will contain any information that identifies you. This way, our de-identified interview transcript can be read by other researchers. The second option, if you don't mind and if you want to be a bit bolder, is to share the entire interview transcript, stripped of sensitive and overly identifying details, i.e. anonymized. In this option, there is a very small chance that someone who knows you well will piece together the details from the interview transcript, narrowing down the choices of who they believe you are among their colleagues. Again, I would like to emphasize that no sensitive information will be shared about you. Which of these two options would you prefer?

Speaker: I might prefer the second option.

Interviewer: Okay. All right. Thank you very much again for participating in this study. I want you to know that this study has been done in the Philippines, Brazil, the Netherlands, France and Africa. For this study to be successful, there is one last thing we would like to ask you, if it is okay with you. Can you nominate or suggest two close people in your life? We will ask them to suggest other couples who might be interested in this work. We will also ask them for couples that you do not know or have not interacted with. In this way we are starting to reach out to as diverse a range of participants as possible. Is this suitable for you?

Speaker: I couldn't understand much, but I would appreciate it if you could zoom in on the microphone again.

Interviewer: Let's do it this way. We actually had one last request from you. I asked if you could suggest two close people in your life as candidates, if they are suitable for you. We ask them to suggest other couples who might be interested in this work. We will also ask them for couples that you don't know or have not interacted with. In this way we are starting to reach out to as diverse a range of participants as possible. Is this suitable for you?

Speaker: Suitable.

Interviewer: So, if you would like to share right now or afterwards on [Social Media] if you would like to share these nominees in your life, that would be great for us. Thank you very much.

Speaker: Okay, do you want a contact number, do you want an e-mail?

Interviewer: Whatever they or you prefer, it makes no difference to us.

Speaker: Okay, I'll [Social Media] you the contact numbers.

Interviewer: Okay, thank you very much. We may contact them today or tomorrow after your sharing. We would also be grateful if you could let them know in advance so that when we contact them they don't leave us unanswered.

Speaker: All right, thank you.

Interviewer: Thank you very much [Participant's Name] for your time and interest. Thank you very much.

Speaker: You're welcome. Have a good day.

Interviewer: Well, I'm going to close the recording. After the recording, if there is any off-the-record information you would like to share...